



THE KENTUCKY ODDFELLOW

Editor Bruce Fortin

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August 2025

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GRAND MASTER

LAYING OF THE WREATH AT THE TOMB OF THE UNKNOWNNS



TOP LEFT & MIDDLE: Grand Master Grand Lodge of KY Independent Order of Odd Fellows (IOOF) Craig Stanfield and Rebecca President Grand Lodge of KY IOOF Casey Puckett in line to lay the wreath on the Tomb of the Unknowns. FAR RIGHT, TOP ROW: Grand Master Stanfield and Rebecca President Puckett hand the wreath to the Aide to the Guard at Arlington National Cemetery. BOTTOM LEFT: Craig & Beverly Stanfield and Casey Puckett with Kentucky's wreath at the Tomb of the Unknowns. MIDDLE: Wreaths laid at the base of the stairs leading to the Tomb of the Unknowns. BOTTOM RIGHT: The Tomb of the Unknowns and the Guard stationed therewith, Arlington National Cemetery.

The Event was the 91st Independent Order of Odd Fellows Pilgrimage to the Tomb. The Sovereign Grand Master placed a wreath at the top of the monument, and wreaths from 40 states (with 38 states providing participating members to lay the wreaths) were laid at the base of the stairs approaching the Tomb of the Unknowns.

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Read the Riot Act

Common Sayings

Meaning: Give someone a strong warning that they must improve their behavior.

Origin: In 18th century England the Riot Act was a legal document that was read aloud in front of a crowd bigger than 12 people that were considered a threat to peace. A public official would read a small part of the Act and order people to leave peacefully within an hour, anyone that remained after one hour was subject to arrest or removal by force.

Paint The Town Red

Meaning: Go out and enjoy oneself flamboyantly.

Origin: There are two versions on how this idiom came to be used. First, it is believed that back in 1837 a famous mischief maker known as the 'Marquis of Waterford' had a wild night out with his group of friends, during which they knocked over flowerpots, pulled knockers off doors and even broke windows. One of their biggest acts of vandalism was painting the doors of several homes with red paint. The other version of the story says that the origin of this idiom might have originated from the brothels of the American West, where they referred to drunk men behaving as if the whole town was a red-light district.

Beat About the Bush

Meaning: Discuss a matter without coming to the point.

Origin: Beating about the bush is an action performed while hunting, driving birds and other animals out into the open. After this was done others would then catch the animals.

Grand Masters Picnic



June 14th Grand Master Craig Stanfield held our Annual Picnic at the Lions Club Fairgrounds in Tollesboro, Ky. Attended by approximately 57 of our Brothers and Sisters. This was a very busy day for our GM because he was to be an auctioneer to raise funds for Treasure Paws immediately after. Treasure Paws is a group who re-home dogs from the shelter. Though it was a busy day for our GM he did admit his wife did a lot of the work for a successful day of fellowship and friendship. Due to health concerns, our Grand Secretary Arthur Light did not attend. Our Grand Treasurer had a knee replacement and could not attend. Ringgold and DeKalb lodges had the most attendees.



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Odd Fellows honor the dead

We placed tribute to honor your Fellow, Odd Fellow, and Civil War Veteran. The incredible dedication and collaboration of Victor Vogt, Bruce Fortin, and Tom Latham in restoring and commemorating such a significant piece of history. Bruce's research into Big Spring Lodge 826 F&AM and locating the first Lodge Master after the Civil War adds an impressive layer of historical context to this act of remembrance.

Setting the marker for this Veteran whose stone was in pieces is not only a remarkable act of respect but also a way of preserving history for future generations. Honoring our Brother in Arms and Odd Fellow in such a heartfelt way reflects the enduring bonds of fraternity and shared values. What a powerful and meaningful accomplishment!



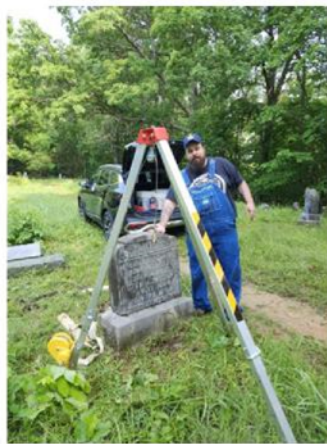
Aaron Lodge Bruce Fortin



Aaron Lodge Victor Vogt



May 31st Members of Aaron Lodge 412 and Masonic Lodge 826 clean and reset stones that were vandalized. New member of Aaron Lodge came out to help. Aaron Lodge Bruce Fortin, Victor Vogt and Daniel Hatfield.



Cleaning and resetting

If anyone is interested in taking on such an endeavor, please contact me. Allow me to get you to the proper channels for cleaning chemicals and tools and the how to. There are many Odd Fellows buried in Odd Fellows cemeteries and small family cemeteries.

A good resource- <https://atlaspreservation.com>

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In Mourning

K D Toney

We are sad to announce the death of a former Odd Fellow and Patriarch Militant General Commanding. Kirjath Dwight (K.D.) Toney, age 91, of Guston, KY, passed away on Thursday, May 8, 2025, at Harrison County Hospital in Corydon, IN.



He was born on September 9, 1933, in New Stithton, KY, son of the late Geroge Dwight Toney and Aretta Hair Toney. Along with his parents, he was preceded in death by his wife, Alice Louise Toney; son, Ricky Lee Toney; siblings, Thomas and Vivian Toney; granddaughter, Priscilla Godwin; and an infant daughter, Brenda Faye Toney.

K.D. was a United States Army Veteran and served as an Army Ranger. He was the proud founder of Lighthouse Team Ministries, a local organization that spread encouragement and love to the community. He loved the Lord and preached the gospel any time he could. His joy in life came from helping others, and he worked tirelessly to fulfill that. K.D. was a loving husband, father, brother, grandfather, and friend, and he will be dearly missed by all those whose lives he touched throughout his ministry.

He is survived by his wife, Elizabeth Toney; children, Cindy Louise Toney, Evelyn Marlene Goff, Jeannie (Walter) Robbins, Doris Ann (P.R.) Rodriguez, James D. (Vivian) Toney, April Lynn Newton, Patricia Ann Gardner, and Frank Newton; brothers, George Michael Toney and Pete Marvin Toney; 13 grandchildren; and 14 great-grandchildren.

Visitation was held at the Alexander Funeral Home on Thursday, May 15, 2025,
Funeral services were held at the Alexander Funeral Home on Thursday, May 15, 2025.



Grand Master Craig Stanfield message:

Grand Lodge will be at DeKalb Lodge#12, 465 Tucker Drive, Maysville, KY, 41056-0547 this year. The memorial service will be 7PM on Sun 12th Oct, Encampment and Banquet is 7PM, Monday the 13th, The Grand Lodge will be held on Tuesday 14 Oct. 2025 at 9am- UTC. Further information TBA. Mark your calendar. We hope to see you there!



Getting older has
some benefits...
Call it a
"Senior Moment"
and you can get
away with pretty
much anything!

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